Himaayah Schools
TEENAGERS BUILDING CIRCLE

GUIDE

الْمَرْءُ عَلَى دِينِ خَلِيلِهِ

"A person is upon the religion of his close friend." (Abū Dāwūd 4833)

Friends and Peer Pressure

Choose good friends, be a good friend, and learn to say no, in person and online.

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمٰنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Before you begin

Your friends shape who you become. The Prophet ﷺ said: “A person is upon the religion of his close friend, so let each of you look at whom he befriends” (Abū Dāwūd 4833, at-Tirmidhī 2378). In the teenage years, friends often matter more than ever, and the wish to fit in can push us towards things we know are wrong.

This guide helps Muslim teenagers choose good friends, be a good friend, recognise peer pressure, say no without losing face, handle online pressure, and know what to do when a friendship turns harmful. It ends with practice scenarios and a short plan.

> الْأَخِلَّاءُ يَوْمَئِذٍ بَعْضُهُمْ لِبَعْضٍ عَدُوٌّ إِلَّا الْمُتَّقِينَ
>
> **“Close friends, that Day, will be enemies to one another, except the righteous.”**
>
> Az-Zukhruf 43:67.

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Part 1 Why friends matter

The Prophet ﷺ gave a picture every teenager can remember:

The musk-seller and the blacksmith

"The example of a good companion and a bad companion is like the seller of musk and the blacksmith. The seller of musk will either give you some, or you will buy from him, or at least you will enjoy a pleasant smell. The blacksmith will either burn your clothes, or you will get a bad smell from him."

(al-Bukhārī 5534, Muslim 2628)

You do not have to do what your friends do to be changed by them. Spending time together slowly changes what feels normal: how you speak, what you laugh at, how you treat prayer, how you treat your parents. On the Day of Judgement some will say: "Woe to me! I wish I had not taken so-and-so as a close friend" (al-Furqān 25:28).

Part 2 Choosing good friends

Look for a friend who…	Be careful of a friend who…
Reminds you of Allah and encourages your prayer	Mocks your prayer, hijab, beard or deen
Is honest, even when it is hard	Lies easily, to you or to others
Wants good for you and is happy at your success	Is jealous, or only around when they need something
Respects your parents and your boundaries	Pushes you to hide things from your parents
Keeps your secrets and does not backbite	Gossips about everyone; they will gossip about you
Works hard at school and has goals	Pulls you away from study, and wastes your time

Good friends are made, not only found

Join places where good people already gather: the masjid, a Qur'an class, sports clubs, school societies, the Teenagers Building Circle. Make duʿāʾ for righteous companions.

Part 3 Being a good friend

"None of you truly believes until he loves for his brother what he loves for himself" (al-Bukhārī 13, Muslim 45). Be the friend you want to have:

- **Greet them** with salām, visit them when they are ill, and accept their invitations (Muslim 2162).
- **Keep their secrets** and defend their honour when they are absent.
- **Advise them gently, in private**, when they do wrong. "The religion is sincere advice" (Muslim 55).
- **Forgive their mistakes** and do not hold grudges.
- **Help them** in their studies and their deen, and make duʿāʾ for them in their absence; an angel says "and for you the same" (Muslim 2732).
- **Never mock** them, or join others who do (al-Ḥujurāt 49:11).

Part 4 Understanding peer pressure

Peer pressure is the push, spoken or unspoken, to do what others in your group do. It can be **positive** (friends who make you study harder or pray on time) or **negative**.

Type	What it looks like
Direct	“Just try it.” “Don’t be a coward.” “Everyone is doing it.”
Indirect	Everyone laughs at a joke, wears a style, or skips class; you feel left out if you don’t.
Online	Dares and challenges, pressure to share photos, to join mocking in a group chat, or to post to look cool.
Self-pressure	Imagining what others will think, even when no one has said anything.

Common pressures: smoking and vaping, drugs and alcohol, skipping prayer or school, dating and inappropriate relationships, cheating in exams, bullying, betting, and showing off what you own.

Part 5 How to say no

1. **Say it clearly:** “No, I don’t do that.” You do not owe a long explanation.
2. **Use your values:** “It’s against my deen” is a complete answer. Many respect it more than you expect.
3. **Suggest something else:** “Let’s play ball instead,” or “I’m going to the masjid, come with me.”
4. **Use humour:** a light reply can end the pressure without a fight.
5. **Repeat yourself** calmly if they push: “I said no.”
6. **Leave:** walk away or make an excuse to go. Your safety matters more than looking polite.
7. **Bring a friend who agrees:** it is far easier to say no when you are not alone.

Remember

Allah sees you when no one else does: “Does he not know that Allah sees?” (al-ʿAlaq 96:14). True friends will still be there after you say no. Those who leave were not real friends.

Part 6 Online pressure

- **Never share** private photos or personal information, even with a friend. Screenshots last forever, and friendships change.
- **Leave group chats** where people mock others, share indecent content or plan wrong.
- **Do not join dangerous “challenges”** for likes; some have injured and killed young people.
- **Likes are not your worth.** People post their best moments, not their real lives.
- **If someone threatens or blackmails you online**, do not pay or send more. Tell a parent or trusted adult at once, and keep the evidence.

Part 7 When a friendship goes wrong

Sometimes a friend keeps pulling you towards harm, or treats you badly. You can step away without cruelty:

- Advise them first, privately and kindly.
- If nothing changes, spend less time with them, especially alone.
- Stay polite: greet them, and do not backbite or expose them.
- Keep making duʿāʾ for their guidance.
- If you feel unsafe, bullied or threatened, tell a parent, teacher or trusted adult. This is not "snitching"; it is protecting yourself and others.

Practice What would you do?

Scenario	A good response
At a party, a friend offers you a vape: "Just one pull, no one will know."	"No thanks, I don't do that." Allah knows. Change the subject or move away.
Your group plans to skip the afternoon class.	"I'm going to class, I can't afford to miss it." Go, even if alone.
Classmates are laughing at a new student in the group chat.	Don't laugh or forward. Say "That's not cool," or leave the chat. Be kind to the student.
A friend asks for your answers in the exam.	"I can't; we could both lose the paper." Offer to study together before the next one.
Your friends call you "too religious" for leaving to pray.	Smile and go. "I'll be back in ten minutes." Consistency earns respect.

Plan My plan

Question	My answer
Three friends who bring me closer to good:	
One situation where I find it hard to say no:	
What I will say or do next time:	
A good place where I can meet good friends:	
One way I will be a better friend this week:	

Parents A word to parents

- Know your child's friends and their families; welcome them into your home.

- Listen more than you lecture, so your child comes to you when something goes wrong.
- Help your child join good environments: classes, sports and youth programmes.
- Talk openly about vaping, drugs, betting and online risks before they meet them.

Test Self-test

Choose the best answer. The answers follow the questions.

1. **"A person is upon the religion of…"**
   a) His teacher b) His close friend c) His country d) His school

2. **In the ḥadīth, the good companion is like:**
   a) The blacksmith b) The seller of musk c) A farmer d) A trader of gold

3. **Peer pressure can be:**
   a) Only negative b) Only online c) Positive or negative d) Only from strangers

4. **If someone blackmails you online, you should:**
   a) Pay quickly b) Send what they ask c) Tell a trusted adult and keep the evidence d) Delete everything and say nothing

5. **Which verse says close friends will be enemies on that Day except the righteous?**
   a) Az-Zukhruf 43:67 b) Al-Fātiḥah 1:5 c) Al-Kawthar 108:1 d) Al-Baqarah 2:286

6. **A good way to say no is:**
   a) Give a long apology b) Say it clearly and suggest something else c) Agree and then regret d) Shout at them

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	b) His close friend	4	c) Tell a trusted adult
2	b) The seller of musk	5	a) Az-Zukhruf 43:67
3	c) Positive or negative	6	b) Say it clearly, suggest something else

Join the Teenagers Building Circle

Ages 13 to 19 · four live sessions a week: deen, education, skills and personal development, with a dedicated facilitator, and a circle of good friends.

Learn more: himaayahschools.com/teenagers-building-circle

General line (WhatsApp): +234 704 722 6487

وَمَا تَوْفِيقِي إِلَّا بِاللَّهِ

"And my success is only through Allah." (Hūd 11:88)

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Choose your friends, choose your future.

This guide from the Himaayah Teenagers Building Circle helps teens build good friendships and stand firm when others push them towards harm.

- The musk-seller and the blacksmith
- What to look for in a friend
- Seven ways to say no
- Group chats, dares and online pressure
- Practice scenarios, a plan and a word to parents

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